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MCA

Company: Nomura

Job Profile: ITD

Offer Type: Internship + (Performance based PPO)

Internship Stipend: 75000

CTC: 11.6 + 2(Joining Bonus) LPA

Location: Powai, Mumbai

Process Date: OA : 31/07/2025,

Placement Process:

1. Pre-placement Talk
2. Aptitude Test
3. Technical Interview 1
4. Technical Interview 2
5. HR Round

1. **Online Aptitude Test** [180+ students appeared]

This was an online aptitude test conducted on MeritTrac's Online Assessment Engine – PARIKSHA, The test consisted of 60 questions, divided equally into **Analytical, Quantitative, and Verbal** sections, with no negative marking. The total time was 60 minutes, so time management was crucial.

The level of difficulty was easy to medium, but the Analytical section had around 8-9 Data Interpretation (DI) questions which were quite lengthy.

A key point — check in advance if a calculator is allowed. In my case, it was allowed, but we were not informed clearly, which made solving DI questions more time-consuming. If calculators aren't allowed, I suggest using the **round-off method** to reach the closest answer faster.

Tip: Start with the Verbal section — passages and sentence-based questions were straightforward. Quants was easy too, but DI can eat up time if you don't plan ahead.

Resources I used:

- **IndiaBix:** Pick a topic, then practice multiple pages, not just the first set — the site has commonly asked questions with clear solutions.
- **YouTube:** *CareerRide Aptitude* is a good channel for learning tricks of aptitude.
https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLpyc33gOcbVA4qXMoQ5vmhefTruk5t9lt&si=GM_wTZqebs-y0zAF

Insider tip: If Nomura is visiting other colleges **a day or two before**, try to connect with students from those campuses — the topics and question patterns are often similar. 😊

2. Technical Interview I [28 candidates were selected]

The list of selected candidates from the aptitude test was declared on 31st July at 7 PM, and my Technical Interview Round 1 was scheduled the very next morning , so there were hardly a few hours to prepare!

How I prepared:

I quickly revised my **Java OOPs concepts**, core **SQL queries** including window functions, self joins and cross joins. I also went through my projects thoroughly — focusing on questions like “*Why did I choose this tech stack?*” and “*What could have been an alternative approach?*”

The interview:

I entered the room, greeted the interviewer and asked permission to sit. He was very polite and friendly. The very first question he asked was, “*What’s the meaning of your name?*”

Then he asked me to introduce myself , he specifically suggested covering my bachelor’s degree, any internships, and the tech stack I worked on.

Tip: While introducing yourself, explain a basic overview of your best-known project — this helps you lead the interview in a direction you’re comfortable with.

After the introduction, he asked me to explain **all my projects briefly**, and my specific role if it was a group project. Next, he asked about my **subjects** during Bachelors and Masters , which ones I liked and disliked. He moved on to, “*Why should we select you? What skills do you have?*” here I highlighted my **strong academic background**, and connected it to my previous answers for example, mentioning that although I didn’t like a particular subject, I still managed a good CGPA.

Then came the practical task:

He asked me to **convert** my e-commerce project (originally in MERN) to Java — and gave me some time to think and explain.

Tip: Always think aloud — even if the interviewer pretends to be busy, they are paying attention to how you approach a problem, not just the final solution.

Unexpected twist:

Midway through, the interview was paused and all candidates were called to give the aptitude test again the panel suspected some unfair practices in the earlier round.

This surprise test had 3 questions:

1. **Aptitude:** *A tap can fill a tank in 10 hrs, B in 8 hrs, and C can empty it in 12 hrs. If all three are open, how long will it take to fill the tank?*
2. **DSA:** *Maximum Subarray Sum* , I wrote the brute force approach, but explained the optimized Kadane’s Algorithm logic too.

3. **SQL:** *Find the employee(s) with the highest salary under each manager.* I didn't remember the exact syntax but mentioned how it could be solved using GROUP BY and window functions (PARTITION BY).

Tip: They don't expect perfect answers they value your approach, logic and thought process more. Write down whatever valid, strong ideas you have.

In any round, explain your thoughts well , clarity and confidence matters!

After the retest, the results were declared out of 28 students, only 7 were selected, out of which 2 were directly promoted to Round 2 , I was one of them. The exact criteria were not disclosed.

3. Technical Interview II [7 candidates were selected out of 28]

This round was much more technical and intense , they really grilled me for almost an hour. There were two panelists in the room. I handed over my resumes and the interview began.

Again, I was asked to introduce myself , **Tip:** Always use words you're confident about, and never fake your resume ,they read every single line carefully.

The first panelist asked which project I was most comfortable with. I chose my AI Interviewer System and explained that I had actually deployed it. She asked me to explain the **entire architecture**, what tech stacks were used, and why I chose them.

Since the project included **session analytics**, she gave me a situation: *"How would you get the analytics for how many people answered a particular question and analyze it based on their scores?"*

I suggested storing each question separately instead of an entire session and comparing strings but she wasn't convinced. I then proposed a DB design change using foreign keys. I asked for hints but realized they were more interested in seeing how I think, so I kept explaining my thoughts in all directions.

Then the second panelist shifted the focus to Data Structures. I honestly said I only had a basic idea. He asked about **HashMaps**, for example: *"Can a key in a HashMap be a class?"* I answered yes, but with constraints, although I couldn't recall all the details. He also asked me about Stack and Heap memory, Object and reference , where are they stored etc.

He asked about sorting algorithms how **Quick Sort**, **Merge Sort** work, their **time complexities**, best & worst cases, **Bubble Sort**, **BST** etc. He also asked me to write short code snippets showing different time complexities as well as the sorting algorithms. I initially mixed up **Bubble Sort** with **Insertion Sort**, but when he cross-questioned, I immediately spotted my mistake and corrected it.

They switched back to another project of mine and asked deep questions about it.

One tricky yet simple question was: *"What happens if you keep pressing the submit button repeatedly but the data hasn't been stored yet?"*

I gave multiple approaches but she wasn't satisfied and kept grilling me, which led to a chain of questions about **REST APIs** the difference between GET, POST, PUT methods, when to use which, how to handle listing all products vs. a single product, and whether parameters can be accessed from the URL in a GET request. I could answer some parts confidently. She then asked me to explain the entire e-commerce

application workflow, cart, wishlist, order, everything as well as authentication and authorization techniques I implemented.

The other panelist asked about my comfort level in Java. I said I knew the basics. He mentioned some advanced concepts I didn't know, and I honestly admitted it. So he switched to **OOPs concepts**. I explained **encapsulation, inheritance**, and also mentioned that multiple inheritance is possible through interfaces. However, since I had just revised Java a day before, I wasn't fully clear on how interfaces enable multiple inheritance internally, so they grilled me on this too. I still shared what I thought could be the reason, showing my thought process.

He then asked, *"How would you design any project?"* I said I'd start with gathering requirements, spend good time finalizing the database design (and I admitted that in my past project, I had picked MongoDB mostly because it's easy to use and scalable, but this interview made me realize there are many more factors to consider).

Suddenly, they shifted to **HR questions**:

- *"What if your project partner is not working?"* I said I'd first try the approach-discuss method, but she wasn't fully convinced, so I added that I'd take necessary steps to inform the reporting manager if required.
- *"What would you do if you want to prove your point and reject another idea?"* — she grilled me here too, testing my approach to conflict resolution.

At the end, I asked for feedback — she said I should expand my thought process more!

Tips:

- Be **confident** about whatever you say — but also make sure it's **logically sound**.
- **Don't bluff** — honesty stands out more than pretending to know everything.
- They test **how you think**, not just how much you know.

4. **HR Round** [3 candidates were selected out of 7]

The HR round was quite relaxed and straightforward. The HR asked me about where I live, and why I chose SPIT despite being rank 1 in the entrance. We spoke about my hobbies, my strong academic background, and why I wanted to work at Nomura. He also asked about my plans for further studies just to understand my long-term goals.

Overall, it was a friendly conversation and a positive way to wrap up the entire process!

All 3 candidates were selected for the ITD role.

Useful Tips:

1. Be honest, don't fake your resume , they *do* read every line and grill you on it. Only mention skills and projects you truly know.

2. If you haven't started with DSA yet, don't panic!

Just do NeetCode 75, focus on understanding how to approach and solve problems, not just memorizing solutions. In real interviews, even a brute force solution works if you explain your thought process well. Knowing an optimized version is always better but the approach is what they test first.

3. For aptitude, IndiaBix is gold.

Don't stop at the first few pages of any topic — the later questions are often more relevant and closer to real test patterns.

4. Keep a smiling face and maintain a pleasant vibe , a positive attitude goes a long way, even when you don't know an answer.

5. Be open to discussions.

If you're wrong or stuck, don't bluff , justify your thoughts, explain your logic. They care about how you think, not just about "perfect" answers.

6. Control what you can , but remember, LUCK PLAYS A BIG ROLE TOO!

Focus on your preparation, stay confident, and trust the process.